Concept Note: PSC Form Submission Tracker

Digitization of PSC Form Submissions and Progress Tracking — Public Service Commission of Vanuatu

Innovation and Digital Development Unit (IPDU), Public Service Commission

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1. Introduction

The Public Service Commission (PSC) of Vanuatu receives a significant volume of form submissions from ministries and departments across the public service. These submissions cover a broad range of human resource and administrative matters — from recruitment and

establishment variations to leave approvals, training applications, and disciplinary actions — and are governed by the PSC's statutory assessment obligations under the Public Service Act.

At present, this process is managed primarily through manual, paper-based procedures. Forms are physically received at the PSC front desk, assessed by PSC Officers, and progressed through an internal review cycle that may involve deferral, resubmission, Commission tabling, and a formal decision. A prior attempt was made to use the vTiger CRM platform for tracking, but it was found to be ill-suited to PSC's specific statutory workflow, as discussed later in this note.

This Concept Note proposes the development of the **PSC Form Submission Tracker** — a lightweight, purpose-built web platform designed and maintained by the IPDU — to digitise the recording and tracking of PSC form submissions from the point of receipt at PSC through to final Commission decision. The system also integrates **Claude AI** (Anthropic) to assist PSC Officers with drafting formal correspondence, checking submission completeness, preparing assessment memoranda, and generating management summaries — reducing routine administrative workload and improving the quality and consistency of PSC communications.

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2. Background and Problem Statement

2.1 The Current Process

When a public servant from a ministry or department needs to submit a PSC form, the process broadly follows these steps:

1. The public servant completes the relevant PSC form.
2. The form is forwarded to the Department Admin Officer for processing.
3. The Admin Officer obtains Director endorsement.
4. The form is escalated to the Ministry Director-General for signature.
5. The DG-endorsed form is physically or electronically sent to the PSC.
6. The form is received at the PSC and assigned to an assessing officer.
7. The PSC assesses the form within a 21-working-day window.
8. The form may be deferred for amendments, resubmitted, forwarded to the Commission, or finalised.

Commented [C1]: MISSING: PSC intake and routing step. The workflow diagram shows that before any assessment begins, the PSC receptionist receives the submission, registers it, and routes it to the correct manager — ODU for restructures, Manager HR for recruitment/HR matters, and VIPAM for study requests. A deadline is also attached at this point. This intake and routing step is not described in Section 2.1 nor reflected in the proposed workflow stages in Section 4.4. It should be added as the first stage in the system, before 'Under Assessment'.

Commented [C2]: IMPRECISE: Ministry-side submission steps. Section 2.1 describes a 'public servant' completing the form, but the PSSRM and our process mapping confirm it is specifically the HR Manager of the ministry who prepares the submission paper with supporting documents. The Director endorsement and DG signature steps are correct, but the originating actor should be updated to 'Ministry HR Manager' for accuracy.

2.2 Key Problems with the Current Manual Approach

The absence of a centralised digital tracking system creates a number of operational challenges for the PSC:

No centralised record of received forms. Forms received at the PSC front desk are tracked informally — via spreadsheets, email records, or physical registers — with no single authoritative source of truth. This makes it difficult for management to see, at any given moment, how many forms are in the system, at what stage, and who is responsible.

No systematic enforcement of the 21-working-day assessment window. The PSC has a statutory obligation to assess submissions within 21 working days. Without a system to record the date assessment formally begins, it is difficult to monitor compliance with this timeframe or identify submissions that are overdue.

Ministries and departments cannot track their submissions. Once a form is sent to the PSC, ministry and department staff have no way to check its status without making a phone call or sending an email. This places an administrative burden on PSC staff who must respond to status enquiries.

No aggregated reporting. PSC management and the Commission currently have limited ability to run reports on submission volumes, trends by ministry, form type, outcomes, or assessment timelines. All such analysis requires manual compilation of records.

Risk of lost or misplaced forms. Physical forms can be lost, misfiled, or damaged. Without a digital log of what has been received, it is difficult to recover the history of a submission or verify whether a form was ever lodged.

No audit trail. Each decision point in the assessment process — deferral, resubmission, Commission tabling, approval or rejection — is not systematically recorded against the individual submission.

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3. Prior System Considered: vTiger CRM

The PSC previously utilised **vTiger**, a widely-used open-source CRM platform, in an attempt to track the workflow of form submissions coming in for Commission approval. This section documents the findings from that experience and explains why a purpose-built solution is being proposed in its place.

3.1 What is vTiger?

vTiger is a general-purpose Customer Relationship Management (CRM) platform originally designed for sales, marketing, and customer support operations. It exists in two forms:

- **vTiger Cloud** — a paid, hosted SaaS product at vtiger.com, priced at USD $12–$66 per user per month depending on the tier. Data is hosted on vTiger's overseas servers.
- **vTiger Open Source / Community Edition** — a free, self-hosted version of the same software, available for download and deployment on a local or cloud server. The organisation is responsible for all installation, maintenance, updates, and backups.

Both versions are feature-rich platforms with over 500 capabilities spanning sales pipelines, marketing automation, helpdesk ticketing, SLA management, and more.

3.2 Why vTiger Was Not the Right Fit for PSC

While vTiger offers powerful workflow and case management capabilities, several factors made it unsuitable as a long-term tracking solution for PSC form submissions:

Designed for commercial, not government HR workflows. vTiger's underlying model is built around managing *customers*, *sales deals*, and *support tickets* — not government HR form submissions. Mapping PSC's statutory intake and assessment workflow onto this model required significant configuration effort and resulted in a system that approximated, but did not accurately reflect, the real process.

Incorrect workflow assumptions built in. The vTiger implementation treated form submission as originating from the ministry side (akin to a customer raising a ticket). The correct model — where tracking begins only when a PSC Officer physically receives and logs the form — is not a natural fit for a CRM ticketing framework.

Data sovereignty concerns (Cloud version). Using vTiger Cloud would mean PSC submission data — including ministry HR records and Commission decisions — is stored on servers outside Vanuatu. This raises significant data sovereignty and confidentiality concerns for a statutory body.

High maintenance burden (Open Source version). Self-hosting vTiger requires a PHP/MySQL server environment, ongoing patching, and system administration skills. This overhead is disproportionate for an organisation that needs a simple, reliable tracking tool.

Vendor dependency and cost risk (Cloud version). Subscription-based pricing means ongoing costs for as long as the system is used. If vTiger changes its pricing or discontinues a tier, PSC has no alternative without a costly migration.

Training complexity. vTiger's breadth of features — most of which PSC would never use — creates a steep learning curve for PSC Officers who need a simple, task-focused interface.

3.3 Comparison: vTiger vs PSC Form Submission Tracker

	vTiger Cloud	vTiger Open Source	PSC Form Submission Tracker
Cost	USD $12–$66/user/month	Free software; server + IT costs (~$20–50/month)	Free — built in-house by IPDU
Ongoing licence fees	Yes	No	No
Data hosted in Vanuatu	No ⚠	Yes ✓	Yes ✓
Owned and controlled by PSC/IPDU	No	Partially	Yes ✓

	vTiger Cloud	vTiger Open Source	PSC Form Submission Tracker
Fits PSC's actual workflow	No — requires heavy customisation	No — same problem	Yes — built for this workflow exactly
21-day assessment clock	Approximated via SLA rules	Same	Purpose-built
Ministry read-only portal	Possible (paid add-on)	Complex to configure	Built-in, role-based
Staff training burden	High (500+ features, complex UI)	High	Low (only what PSC needs)
Maintenance burden	None (vendor managed)	High (IT team manages)	Medium (IPDU manages, simple codebase)
Vendor/subscription risk	High	Low	None
Internet required	Yes	Depends on hosting	No (can run on local network)

3.4 Conclusion on vTiger

vTiger is a capable platform for its intended purpose — managing commercial customer relationships. For PSC's use case, it is the equivalent of using a sales system to run a government case register: it can be made to work, but it never fits naturally, requires constant re-configuration, and creates ongoing technical and financial overhead. The PSC Form Submission Tracker is proposed as a purpose-built replacement that correctly models PSC's statutory process, costs nothing to license, keeps data within Vanuatu, and is maintained entirely by IPDU.

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4. Proposed Solution: PSC Form Submission Tracker

4.1 Overview

The PSC Form Submission Tracker is a role-based web application that allows PSC Officers to log each form received from a ministry or department and track it through every stage of the assessment and decision process. Ministry and department staff will have read-only access to view the current status of their submissions.

Tracking begins when a PSC Officer logs the received form. There is no pre-submission or draft stage in the system. The form exists in the physical or email world until a PSC Officer records its receipt — at which point a unique reference number is assigned (format: `PSC-YYYY-XXXXX`) and the tracking lifecycle begins.

4.2 Proposed System Architecture

The system is proposed to be built as a full-stack web application consisting of:

- A **backend API** built with Django (Python) and Django REST Framework, backed by a PostgreSQL database.
- A **frontend web interface** built with React, accessible from any modern browser without requiring software installation.
- A **Redis** instance for session and caching management.
- Deployment via Docker containers, hosted on a server managed by IPDU.

The system is designed to run entirely within the PSC's infrastructure and does not depend on external cloud services for core functionality.

4.3 Proposed User Roles

The system defines six user roles, each with appropriate permissions:

Role	Description	Create Submissions	View Submissions	Transition Workflow
PSC Officer	Logs forms, runs assessments	Yes (all ministries)	All	Yes
PSC Secretary	Forwards to Commission	Yes	All	Yes
PSC Commissioner	Records Commission decisions	No	All	Yes (decisions only)
PSC Admin	Full system administration	Yes	All	Yes
Ministry HR Officer	Tracks ministry submissions	No	Ministry only	No
Department Admin Offic	Tracks department submissions	No	Department only	No

Role	Description	Create Submissions	View Submissions	Transition Workflow
er				

4.4 Proposed Workflow Stages

Once a PSC Officer logs a received form into the system, the submission progresses through the following stages.

The diagram below shows the **end-to-end process**: first, the ministry-side steps that happen *before* any digital record exists; then the **PSC-tracked** stages from the moment a PSC Officer logs the form (reference PSC-YYYY-XXXXX assigned) through to final Commission decision or withdrawal.

Commented [C3]: INCOMPLETE: Commission sitting detail. The concept note treats the Commission stage as a single event, but the workflow shows a structured sitting: (1) Commission adopts the meeting agenda — submissions are ordered by category priority: discipline first, then recruitment, restructure, then study/HR matters; (2) previous meeting minutes are endorsed before new business begins; (3) the Commission deliberates each submission and records a decision. The system should capture the agenda category and Commission meeting date as fields on each submission, and the category-ordering logic should be documented in the concept note.

Commented [C4]: MISSING: Manager checklist stage. After routing by the receptionist, each responsible manager (ODU, HR, or VIPAM) performs a checklist review of the submission before it is progressed. This is a formal quality gate — if the checklist passes, the manager takes the submission to the PSC Secretary for sign-off. This stage is absent from Section 4.4. Suggest adding a 'Manager Checklist Review' stage with the responsible manager as actor, and a pass/fail outcome (fail = returned to ministry; pass = forwarded to Secretary).

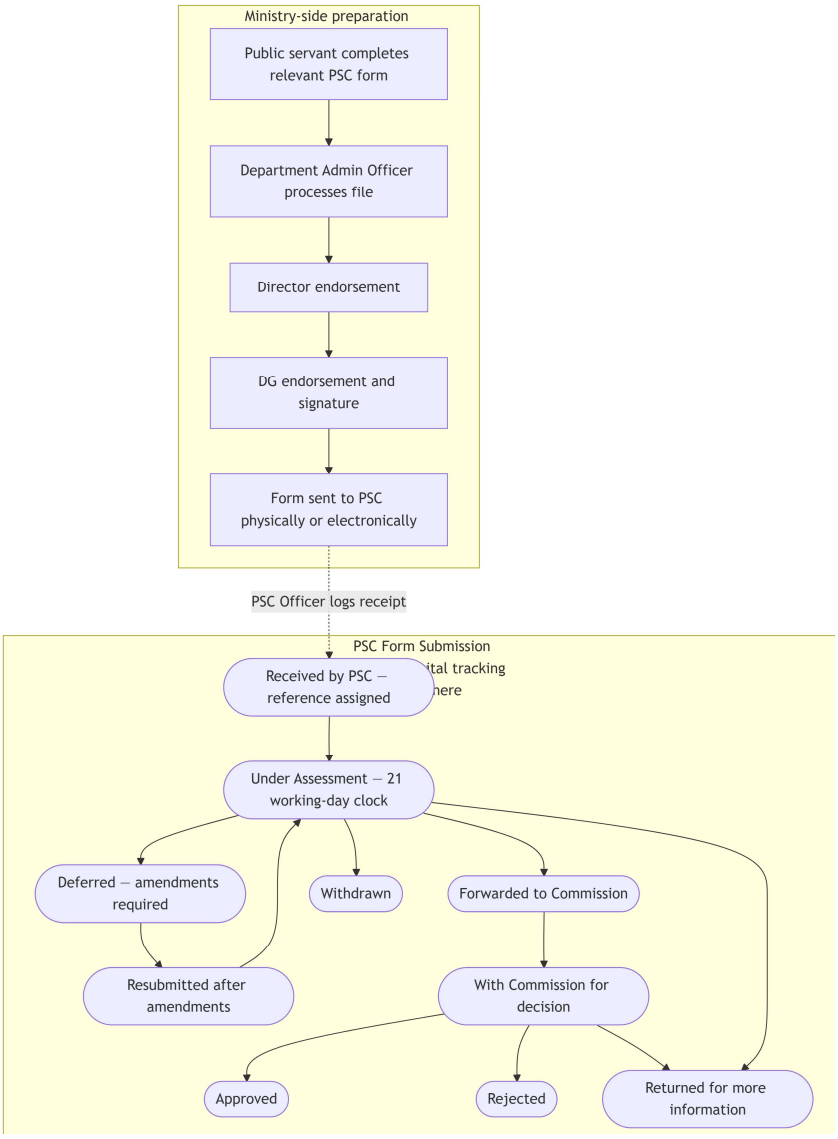


Figure 1. End-to-end PSC form workflow: ministry preparation is not recorded in the tracker; the **PSC Officer's log step** is the first digital event. Dashed arrow: form reaches PSC but is not

tracked until logged. Branching reflects common paths; exact routes may vary by form category and case.

The table below lists each tracker **status** and who triggers it.

Stage	Triggered by	Description
Received by PSC	PSC Officer logs form	Reference number assigned; DG endorsement noted; tracking begins
Under Assessment	PSC Officer starts review	Formal assessment begins; 21-working-day clock starts
Deferred	PSC Officer	Ministry/department required to make amendments before resubmission
Resubmitted	PSC Officer (on receipt of revised form)	Ministry has responded; assessment clock restarts
Forwarded to Commission	PSC Secretary	Form placed on Commission meeting agenda
Approved	PSC Commissioner	Commission approves the submission
Rejected	PSC Commissioner	Commission rejects the submission
Returned	PSC Officer / Commissioner	Further information required before a decision can be made
Withdrawn	PSC Officer	Submission withdrawn by the ministry/department

Each stage transition is recorded as a **workflow step**, capturing who acted, when, and any remarks. This creates a complete, immutable audit trail for every submission.

4.5 Proposed Form Categories

The system will support tracking of submissions across all PSC form categories:

Category	PSC Forms
Organisation & Structure	PSC 2.1 (Org Restructure), PSC 2.2 (Job Description), PSC 2.1 (Establishment Variation)
Recruitment	PSC 3-1, 3-5, 3-6/7, 3-8
Leave & Travel	PSC 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 4.8, 4.9
Allowances & Claims	PSC 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.7, 4.10, 4.11
Training & Development	PSC 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4, 5.5, 5.6
Discipline	PSC 6.2, 6.3, 6.4
Housing & Vehicles	PSC 8.1, 8.2, 9.1, 9.3

Commented [C5]: MISSING: PSC Secretary sign-off gate. Before a submission can go to the Commission, the PSC Secretary reviews it and signs off — confirming it has merit to be tabled. This is a distinct and important step between the manager checklist and 'Forwarded to Commission'. The current workflow table in Section 4.4 jumps directly from assessment to 'Forwarded to Commission' without capturing this gate. Add a 'Secretary Sign-Off' stage where the Secretary is the actor and the outcome is either signed (proceed to Commission) or returned to the responsible manager.

Commented [C6]: MAJOR GAP: Post-decision implementation loop is entirely absent from this concept note. After the Commission sitting, the workflow shows a full implementation cycle: (1) Secretary drafts the meeting minutes; (2) Commission reads, reviews, prints and signs the minutes; (3) signed minutes are saved to Salmon (the PSC shared drive); (4) Manager CSU enters each decision into Vtiger and assigns it to the responsible manager; (5) each manager assigns to their officers; (6) officers action the decisions and update their status; (7) Secretary extracts a Vtiger report showing implemented vs not implemented vs overdue; (8) the report is shared with all managers and the Commission. This entire loop needs its own section in the concept note and its own set of system requirements. It is arguably the most operationally important part of the process being replaced.

Commented [C7]: MISSING: Post-decision implementation statuses. The workflow diagram identifies five status values needed after a Commission decision: Implemented, In Progress, Not Implemented, Overdue, and Deferred/N/A. These are not in the workflow stages table in Section 4.4. A new set of post-decision stages should be added, along with the actors responsible for updating them (officers action, managers oversee, Secretary monitors).

Category	PSC Forms
Performance	PSC 10.2, 10.4a
Other	Local Purchase Orders (LPO), Miscellaneous

4.6 Proposed Key Features

4.6.1 Dashboard

A role-sensitive dashboard providing an at-a-glance summary of all submissions visible to the logged-in user, including:

- Total submissions in the system
- Breakdown by status (received, under assessment, deferred, with Commission, etc.)
- Submissions overdue beyond the 21-working-day assessment window
- Charts showing submission volumes by ministry and by form category

4.6.2 Submission Log

A searchable and filterable list of all submissions, with columns for reference number, title, submitting ministry, form type, logged-by officer, current status, and date received. Each row links to the full submission detail page.

4.6.3 Submission Detail and Audit Trail

A detailed view of each submission showing all metadata and a full chronological history of every workflow step, including who acted, when, and any recorded remarks.

4.6.4 Reports

An aggregated reporting view showing submission counts by ministry and by form type, with the ability to export data to CSV for further analysis.

Commented [C8]: MISSING: Escalation and carry-forward mechanism. The workflow shows that overdue or not-implemented decisions are escalated and carried forward to the next Commission sitting agenda. This is a key accountability feature. It should be described in Section 4.6.4 (Reports) or as a dedicated feature — the system should automatically flag overdue items for the next Commission sitting and include them in the implementation report.

4.6.5 Role-Based Access Control

All pages and API endpoints are protected. Ministry and department users can only see submissions from their own ministry/department. PSC staff see all submissions across all ministries. Only PSC Officers, Secretaries, and Admins can log or update submissions.

4.6.6 21-Working-Day Compliance Tracking

The system will flag submissions where the assessment window has been exceeded, providing PSC management with visibility over compliance obligations.

4.6.7 Artificial Intelligence (AI) Assistance

The system integrates the **Claude AI** (developed by Anthropic), one of the world's leading large language models, to assist PSC Officers with routine writing and analytical tasks. All AI features

are accessed directly within the tracker interface — no separate tool or account is required for PSC staff. The AI capabilities are described in full in Section 5.

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5. AI Integration: Claude AI Assistance for PSC Officers

The PSC Form Submission Tracker incorporates **Claude AI** as an integrated assistant for PSC Officers, Secretaries, and management. AI is used exclusively to assist — not to replace — the judgement and decisions of PSC staff. All AI outputs are clearly labelled as AI-generated and must be reviewed and approved by an authorised officer before any action is taken.

The AI integration uses the Claude API provided by Anthropic. Submission data is sent to the Claude API only at the moment an AI feature is used, for the specific submission in question. No data is stored by Anthropic beyond the scope of the individual API call. The API key is held securely on the PSC's own server and is never exposed to end users.

5.1 Feature 1: Completeness Check

Before assessment begins, a PSC Officer can request an instant AI review of the submission to identify anything that appears missing or incomplete based on the form type and standard PSC requirements.

How it works: The officer clicks "Check Completeness" on the submission detail page. Claude analyses the form type, description, and any attached notes and returns a structured report identifying: specific issues found (e.g. missing bonding agreement, no DG endorsement noted), non-blocking warnings, and items that appear correctly in order.

Benefit: Reduces the time spent on back-and-forth deferral cycles by identifying deficiencies at the point of logging, before assessment formally begins.

5.2 Feature 2: Draft Formal Letter

When a submission is deferred, rejected, approved, or returned, the PSC Officer selects the letter type and enters a brief reason. Claude drafts a complete, formally worded letter ready for review and dispatch to the relevant Ministry HR Officer or Director-General.

Letters that can be drafted:

- Deferral letter (amendments required)
- Return letter (additional information requested)
- Approval letter (Commission decision)
- Rejection letter (Commission decision with basis)
- Withdrawal acknowledgement

How it works: The officer selects the letter type, optionally enters a one-line reason, and clicks "Draft letter." Claude produces a complete letter in PSC formal correspondence style, including the date placeholder, addressee block, reference number, subject line, body paragraphs, and sign-off. The officer reviews, edits if needed, and sends.

Benefit: Reduces the time to draft a formal letter from 20–30 minutes to under 5 minutes. Ensures consistent tone, structure, and reference to relevant PSC procedures across all correspondence.

5.3 Feature 3: Assessment Memorandum

When a PSC Officer has completed their assessment and is preparing to forward a submission to the Commission, they can generate a draft assessment memorandum structured for the PSC Secretary and Commission.

How it works: The officer optionally enters brief assessment notes (e.g. "All documents present, JD aligns with establishment"). Claude generates a structured memorandum including background, submission summary, assessment findings, and recommendation. The officer reviews and approves before it is attached to the Commission agenda.

Benefit: Saves significant drafting time for a document that currently requires careful formatting and formal language. Ensures every memo follows a consistent structure.

5.4 Feature 4: Commission Agenda Briefing Paragraph

When a submission is forwarded for Commission consideration, the PSC Secretary needs a concise briefing paragraph for each item on the meeting agenda. Claude generates this from the submission record.

How it works: The Secretary enters an optional recommendation, and Claude produces a 3–5 sentence briefing covering the form type, originating ministry, background, and officer recommendation — ready to paste into the Commission agenda pack.

Benefit: Eliminates a repetitive manual task for the PSC Secretary when preparing for Commission meetings with multiple agenda items.

5.5 Feature 5: Natural Language Search

Rather than navigating dropdown filters, officers can search the full submission register using plain English.

Examples of queries the system understands:

- *"All overdue submissions from MFEM"*
- *"Study leave applications still under assessment"*
- *"Urgent submissions deferred more than once"*
- *"Approved recruitment forms from the last quarter"*

How it works: Claude translates the natural language query into structured database filters, which are applied to the submission register. Results are returned instantly.

Benefit: Makes the submission register accessible to staff who are not familiar with filter interfaces, and enables complex multi-condition queries that would otherwise require manual scanning.

5.6 Feature 6: Natural Language Reports, Dashboard Insights, and Charts

PSC officers and leadership often need answers that span the whole submission register — not a single row — such as comparing workloads across ministries, understanding status distribution, or identifying which form categories dominate the queue. Rather than configuring filters and exporting spreadsheets, users ask in plain English from the **Reports** screen.

Examples of questions:

- *"Which ministries send us the most submissions?"*
- *"Show me a chart of submissions by status"*
- *"What share of items are still under assessment versus with the Commission?"*
- *"Compare training-related forms against recruitment forms"*

How it works: The system first computes **authoritative totals from the PSC database** — counts grouped by ministry, by workflow status, and by PSC form type — scoped to what the user's role is allowed to see. Those aggregates are passed to Claude together with the user's question. Claude returns a plain-language interpretation and recommends whether a bar chart or donut chart best illustrates the answer. The chart itself is rendered from the **same database figures** — the AI never invents counts; it only chooses how to explain and visualize numbers already computed by the system.

Benefit: Turns reporting from a technical exercise into a conversation. Management can explore trends interactively without asking IPDU for custom SQL or spreadsheet pivot tables each time.

5.7 Feature 7: Weekly Management Digest

PSC management and the PSC Secretary can generate an AI-written plain-English summary of the week's submission activity — covering new forms logged, assessments in progress, overdue items, and recent Commission decisions.

How it works: The officer clicks "Generate" on the dashboard. Claude receives a structured data summary of the current week's statistics and produces a professional 2–4 paragraph digest suitable for sharing with PSC leadership.

Benefit: Gives management a fast, readable overview without requiring them to interpret charts or run reports manually. Particularly useful for weekly briefings and management reporting.

5.8 What the AI Does Not Do

It is important to be clear about the boundaries of AI use in this system:

- **The AI does not make decisions.** It drafts, summarises, and checks — all outputs require human review and approval.
- **The AI does not store PSC data.** Submission details are sent to Claude only at the moment of a specific request and are not retained by Anthropic.
- **The AI does not access external systems.** It works only with information available in the PSC Tracker at the time of the request.
- **For reporting and charts, counts are never invented by AI.** Natural-language analytics use database aggregates only; Claude explains and chooses a visualisation — the underlying numbers come from PSC's own PostgreSQL data.
- **AI outputs are clearly labelled.** Every AI-generated text block in the interface carries the label "AI-generated — review before use."

5.9 Summary of AI Features

Feature	Who Uses It	Time Saved (estimate)
Completeness check	PSC Officer (at logging)	10–15 min per submission
Draft formal letter	PSC Officer / Secretary	20–30 min per letter
Assessment memorandum	PSC Officer	30–45 min per memo
Commission agenda briefing	PSC Secretary	10–15 min per agenda item
Natural language search	All PSC staff	Ongoing
Natural language reports, insights & charts	PSC leadership / Officers (Reports page)	15–45 min per management question
Weekly management digest	PSC Secretary / Management	30–60 min per week

6. Prioritised Gaps in the Current Process

The following gaps in the current manual process are prioritised for resolution by the proposed system, ordered from highest to lowest urgency:

6.1 Priority 1 — No Centralised Record of Received Forms (Critical)

Gap: The PSC has no single authoritative register of forms received. Individual officers maintain personal records (email folders, spreadsheets, physical files) that are not consolidated and cannot be accessed by other staff or management.

Impact: If an officer is absent, their pending workload is invisible to colleagues. Management cannot determine, without asking individuals, how many forms are currently in the office and at what stage.

Proposed resolution: Every form received is logged into the tracker by the receiving PSC Officer at the time of receipt. All PSC staff can see the full live register at any time.

6.2 Priority 2 — 21-Working-Day Window Not Systematically Monitored (Critical)

Gap: The PSC has a statutory obligation to assess submissions within 21 working days. The date on which assessment formally begins is not recorded centrally. Overdue assessments are identified reactively, if at all.

Impact: Potential statutory non-compliance; inability to demonstrate accountability to ministries, the Commission, or the Ombudsman.

Proposed resolution: The system records the date assessment begins. It calculates elapsed working days and flags overdue assessments visually on the dashboard and submission list.

6.3 Priority 3 — Ministries Cannot Track Their Own Submissions (High)

Gap: Ministry HR Officers and Department Admin Officers have no visibility into what happens to a form after it is sent to the PSC. They must make phone or email enquiries to check status.

Impact: Inefficiency and frustration on both sides; PSC staff time consumed by status enquiries.

Proposed resolution: Ministry and Department users are given read-only logins. They can see the current status and full history of all submissions from their ministry at any time.

6.4 Priority 4 — No Audit Trail of Decisions (High)

Gap: There is no systematic record linking each decision point (deferral, Commission tabling, approval, rejection) to a specific submission, officer, date, and reason.

Impact: Accountability gaps; difficulty reconstructing the history of a contested or reviewed submission; risk of disputes with ministries.

Proposed resolution: Every status transition is recorded as a timestamped workflow step against the submission, including the officer's name and any remarks.

6.5 Priority 5 — No Aggregated Reporting Capability (Medium)

Gap: PSC management and the Commission cannot run reports on submission volumes, assessment timelines, or outcomes without manually compiling records.

Impact: Limited evidence base for annual reporting, resource planning, and Commission governance.

Proposed resolution: The system provides an aggregated reports view with breakdowns by ministry, form type, and status, with CSV export for further analysis.

6.6 Priority 6 — Risk of Lost or Unacknowledged Forms (Medium)

Gap: Physical forms can be misplaced without any record that they were received. There is no acknowledgement mechanism when a form arrives at the PSC.

Impact: Ministries have no proof of lodgement; PSC has no record if a form is lost after receipt.

Proposed resolution: Logging a form in the system creates an immediate, timestamped record of receipt with a unique reference number. This reference can be communicated to the ministry as proof of lodgement.

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7. Implementation Approach

IPDU can deliver an integrated working build of the core tracker — sufficient for PSC Officers to begin structured pilot testing — **within approximately one week** once scope and priorities are confirmed. Work on hosting should proceed **in parallel**: liaison with **DCDT** should begin immediately so server provisioning, backup arrangements, and deployment paths are ready when the application is handed over.

7.1 Phase 1 — Core Tracker with AI Assistance

Develop and deploy the core PSC Form Submission Tracker, covering:

- User authentication and role management
- Submission logging by PSC Officers (reference number assigned at logging)
- Workflow transitions with full audit trail
- Dashboard and submission list views
- Basic reports and CSV export

- **AI features:** completeness check, draft formal letters, assessment memorandum, Commission agenda briefing, natural language search, natural-language reports and charts (database-backed aggregates), weekly management digest (powered by Claude AI)

AI features are included in Phase 1 because they directly support the core daily tasks of PSC Officers and require no additional infrastructure beyond the Claude API key.

7.2 Phase 2 — Ministry and Department Access

Onboard Ministry HR Officers and Department Admin Officers with read-only portal access, enabling self-service status tracking and reducing the volume of status enquiry calls to PSC staff.

7.3 Phase 3 — Integration and Enhancements

- Document upload against submissions (scanned copies of forms)
- Automated email notifications to ministries when a submission is deferred, approved, or rejected
- Integration with Smartsheet for cross-system data consistency
- API integration with any future PSC HR information system
- Expanded AI capabilities as requirements evolve (e.g. Bislama language support, predictive overdue alerts)

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8. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role in System
PSC Officers	Primary users — log and assess submissions
PSC Secretary	Tables submissions for Commission; records outcomes
PSC Commissioners	Record Commission decisions
PSC Management / IPDU	System oversight and reporting
Ministry HR Officers	View status of ministry submissions (read-only)
Department Admin Officers	View status of department submissions (read-only)
Director-Generals	Informed via ministry HR Officers

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9. Resource Requirements

9.1 Technical Resources

- Server or virtual machine for deployment (Linux-based, managed by IPDU)

- PostgreSQL database
- Domain name and SSL certificate for secure HTTPS access
- Backup and recovery procedure for the database

9.2 Human Resources

- **IPDU Developer(s):** System development, testing, and deployment
- **PSC Officers:** User acceptance testing; workflow validation per form category
- **PSC Management:** Requirements sign-off; stakeholder communication

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10. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Workflow assumptions incorrect for certain form categories	Medium	High	Validate with PSC officers before finalising configuration; allow workflow to be adjusted by PSC Admin
PSC Officers resist adopting the digital log	Medium	High	Involve officers early; keep the logging step simple and fast
Incomplete data if not all received forms are logged	High	Medium	Establish a clear policy that all forms must be logged on the day of receipt
System downtime affecting assessment records	Low	High	Implement daily database backups; document manual fallback procedure
Ministry users bypassing the system and calling PSC directly	Medium	Low	Communicate the portal as the primary channel for status enquiries

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11. Conclusion and Recommended Next Steps

The PSC Form Submission Tracker represents a pragmatic, low-cost step toward digitising a core administrative function of the Public Service Commission. By centralising the logging and tracking of received forms, the system will strengthen accountability, improve compliance monitoring against statutory timeframes, reduce the administrative burden on PSC staff, and provide ministries and departments with transparent visibility into the status of their submissions.

IPDU is currently preparing this document as a **draft Concept Note** for the tracker system. It will be circulated for feedback and revised before formal endorsement.

The following next steps are recommended:

1. **Circulate and endorse** this Concept Note once the draft has been reviewed — securing management endorsement of the proposed scope.
2. **Conduct workflow validation sessions** with PSC Officers to confirm the correct workflow stages per form category and clarify role boundaries (Ministry HR vs. Department Admin).
3. **Confirm infrastructure** — identify the server or hosting environment for deployment.
4. **Develop and test Phase 1** — core submission tracker with PSC internal users only.
5. **Conduct user acceptance testing** with a small group of PSC Officers before full rollout.
6. **Onboard ministry and department users** in Phase 2 following successful internal testing.

IPDU is ready to proceed with development upon receipt of management sign-off and workflow confirmation from PSC Officers.

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